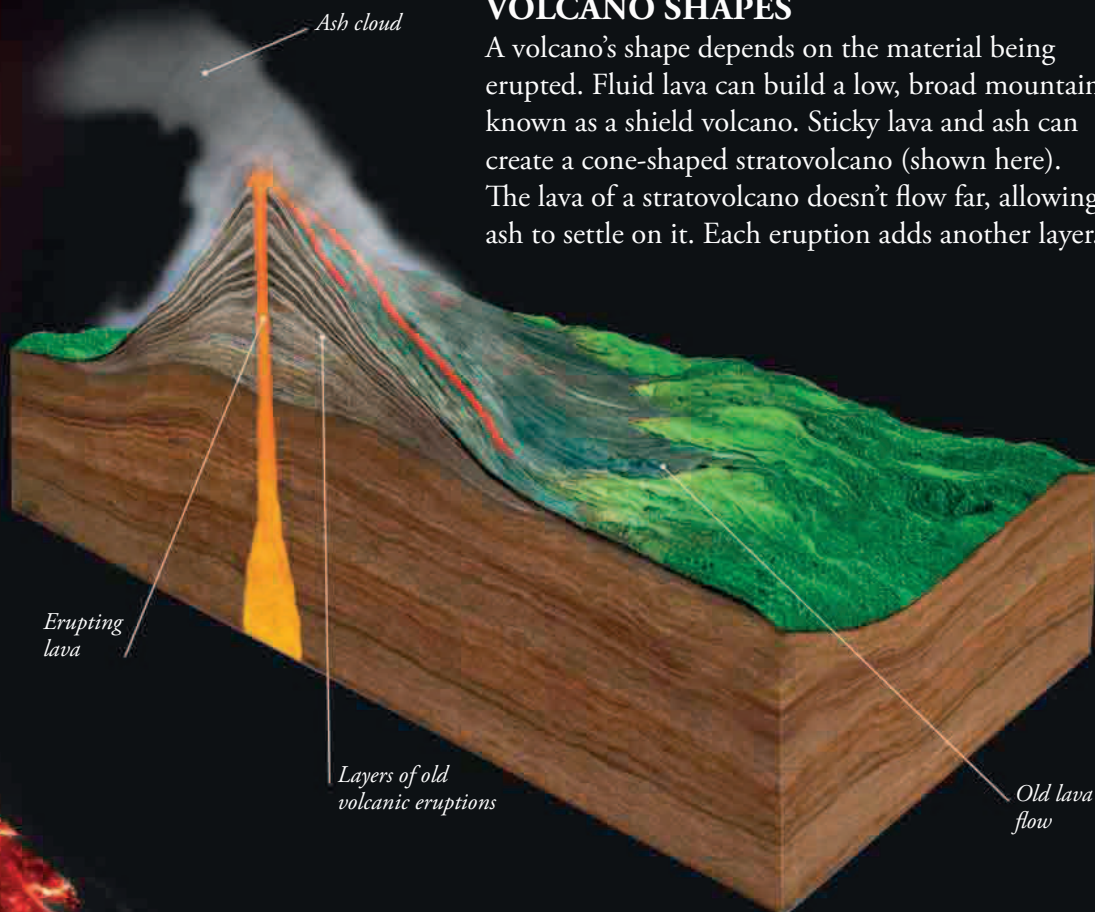




VOLCANO SHAPES

A volcano's shape depends on the material being erupted. Fluid lava can build a low, broad mountain known as a shield volcano. Sticky lava and ash can create a cone-shaped stratovolcano (shown here). The lava of a stratovolcano doesn't flow far, allowing ash to settle on it. Each eruption adds another layer.



► KILLER CLOUD

A billowing, deadly cloud of hot ash threatens to engulf a truck speeding away from the 1991 eruption of Mount Pinatubo in the Philippines.



PYROCLASTIC FLOWS

Much of the rock and ash blasted into the sky during an explosive eruption falls back down again. It pours down the volcano in an avalanche of searingly hot rock and dust called a pyroclastic flow. This can travel at up to 450 mph (700 km/h) and surge far beyond the volcano, incinerating and often burying everything in its path.